REAL TIME INFORMATION CENTER

STUDY SESSION OCTOBER 2026

San Mateo Police Department

AGENDA

I. Introduction	Chief Ed Barberini
II. RTIC Overview	Police Technical Services Administrator Kelly O’Keefe
III. ALPR Technology	Lieutenant Stephan Casazza
IV. Drone as a First Responder	Lieutenant Anthony Riccardi
V. Closing Remarks	Chief Ed Barberini

Who are we?

Think of it as a high-tech command center that bridges the gap between data and frontline action — turning raw information into something officers can use right now to stay safe and be more effective.

ELEMENTS OF AN RTIC

ALPR

Property crime is one of the most prevalent issues impacting communities within the bay area. Stolen vehicles often go hand in hand with package theft, retail theft, and robberies.

INTELLIGENCE

The real time operators are well versed in various intelligence databases and tactics. Timely intelligence allows for officers to identify safety risks and respond more prepared.

FUSUS

Integrating Department drones and public cameras allows the real time information center to get eyes on an active scene within seconds of the call for service - preserving resources and preparing officers for unfolding incidents.

Video Technology in Fusus

Body Worn Cameras

Operators can monitor officer's body worn cameras in real time. When an officer responds to an incident and is thrust into an active situation, the operator can monitor their cameras until their cover responds. This enables a level of officer safety when situations quickly turn in the field.

City Cameras

RTIC operators utilize city-owned cameras to live stream calls for service and special events. The cameras were strategically placed to bring problem areas into view; helping reduce vandalism and other crimes occurring on City-owned property.

Intelligence

Work directly with the reporting parties to get cell phone videos and pictures.

COMMUNICATION

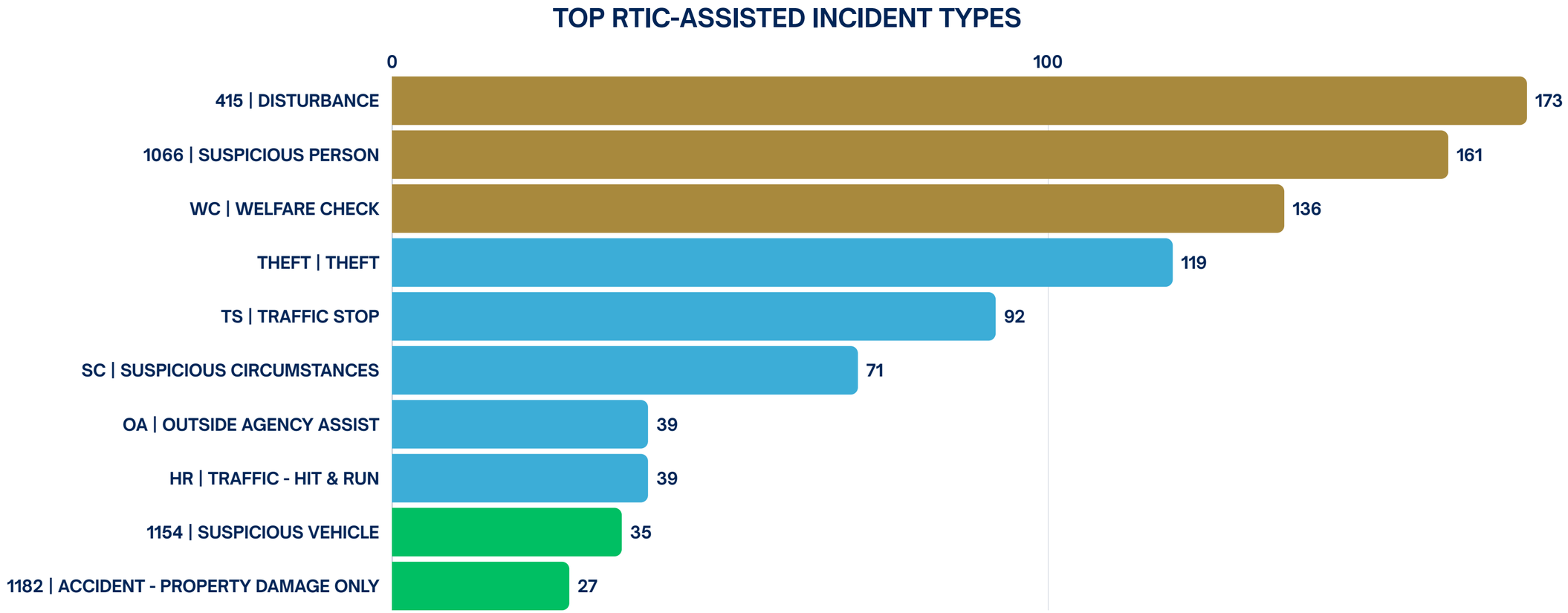
Utilize police databases to retrieve intel within moments of receiving the call- even before an officer arrives on scene.

RESEARCH

Work with field personnel to strategize best use for the operators during preplanned events.

STRATEGY

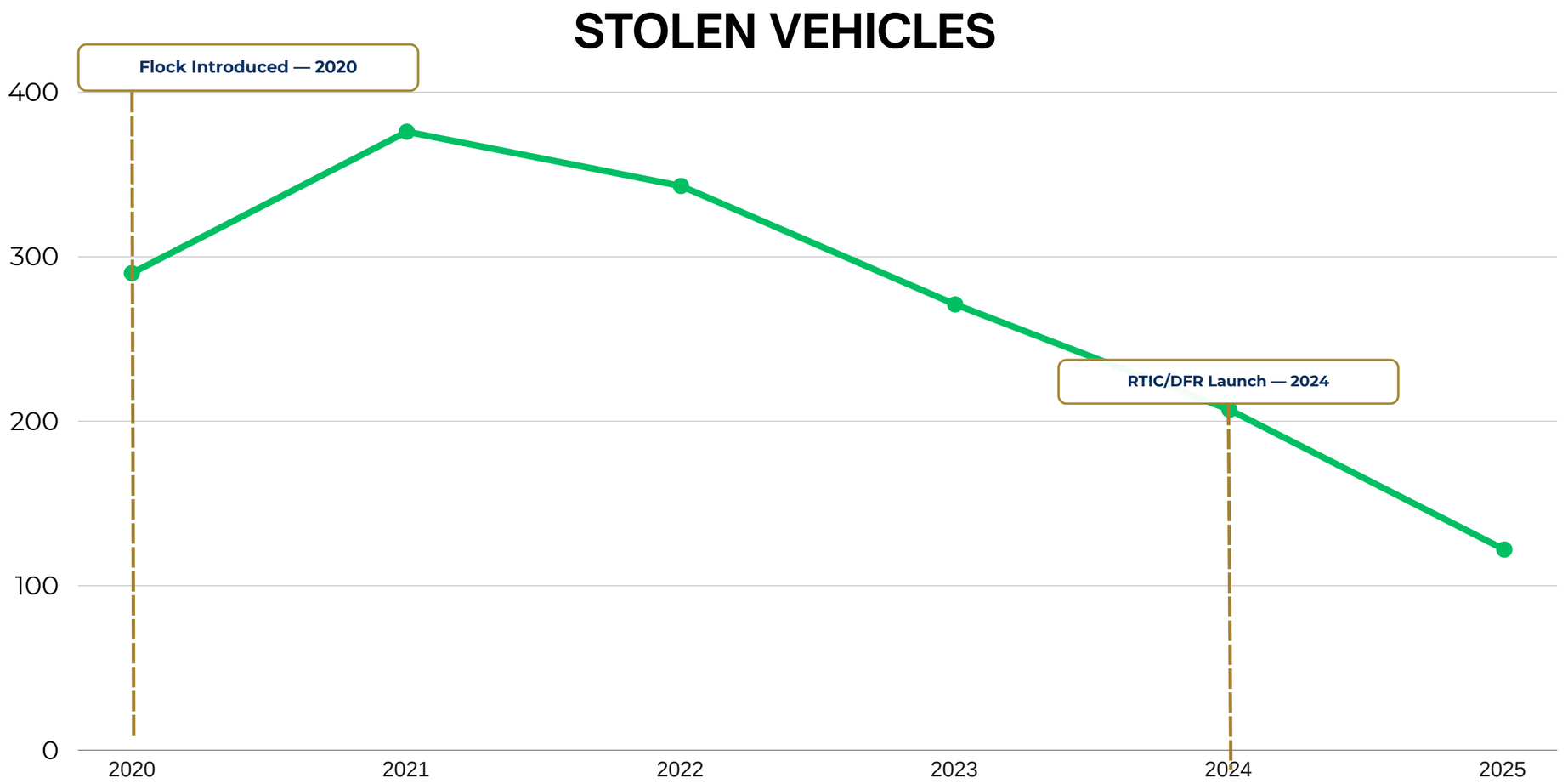
RTIC-Assisted Incidents



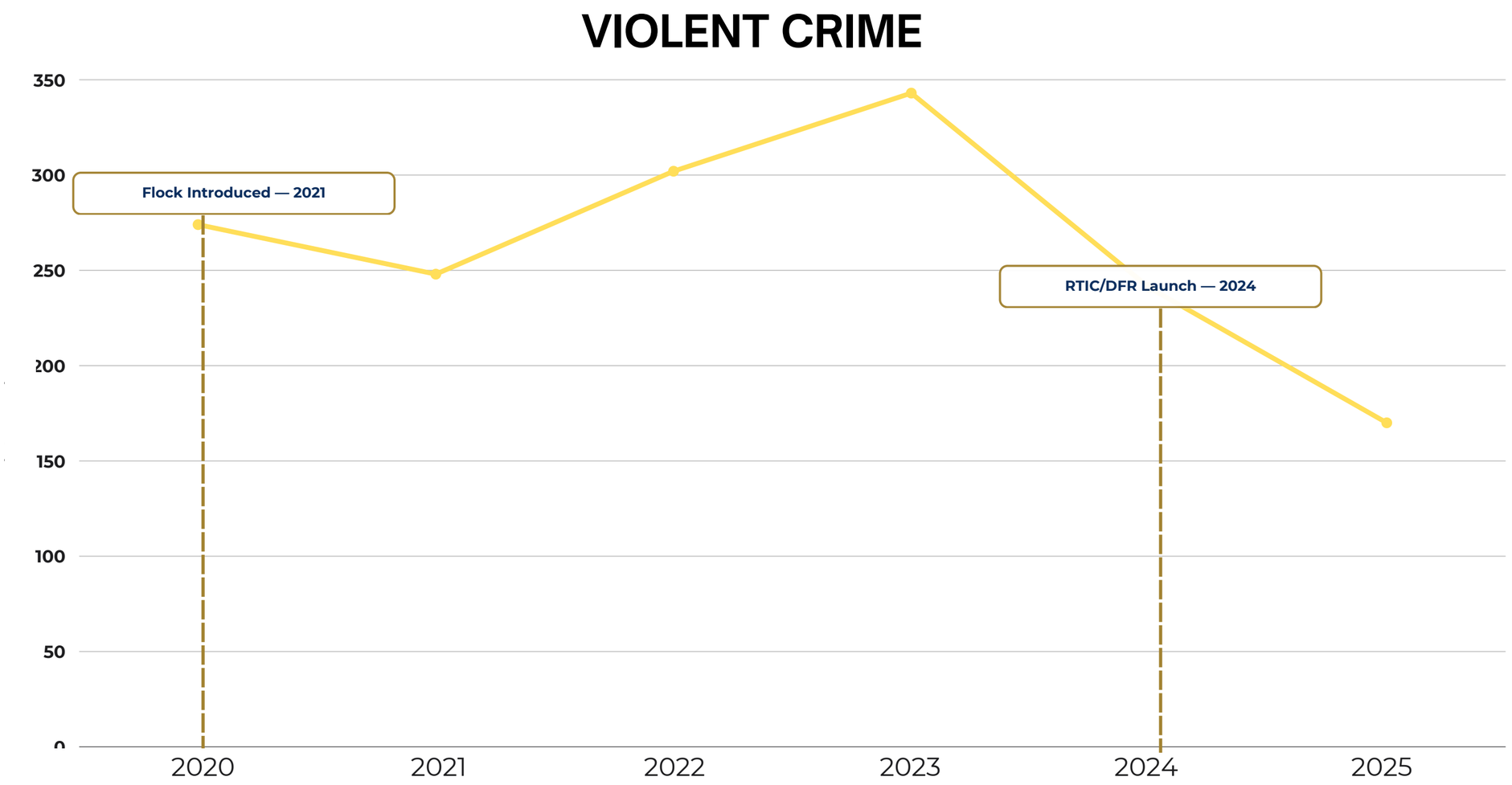
Data from 10/24 to 08/26

SMPD Five Year Crime Trends

SMPD Five Year Crime Trends



SMPD Five Year Crime Trends



RTIC Activity Since October 2024

1,500+

Incidents Assisted

→

418

Cases Generated

→

339

Cases with a Criminal Component

→

79%

Cases with a Suspect Identified

Data from 10/24 to 08/26

Arrest Rates

RTIC-ASSISTED CRIMINAL CASES

339 cases with a criminal component

DEPARTMENT OVERALL

All Department cases during the same period

The two case populations may differ in case type, seriousness, available evidence, or other factors. The rates are shown for descriptive context only; no causal relationship is implied.

CASE STUDY

01
Initial Report
Male in a white Jeep driving erratically and pointing a gun at pedestrians.

02
Limited Details
Officers had minimal information—only a vehicle description.

03
RTIC Intervention
Operator recognized the suspect's M.O. from a similar incident the previous month.

04
Case Link
Retrieved prior case file, identified license plate, and contacted original reporting party.

05
Confirmation
Reporting party verified the vehicle through unique identifiers.

06
Technology Utilized
Operator used ALPR to locate the vehicle near the scene.

Outcome
Officers located and arrested the suspect; the weapon was a replica firearm.

THE FUTURE OF RTIC

Collaboration & Partnerships

Support multi-agency responses and collaborate with other City Departments including Public Works, Community Development, and San Mateo Consolidated Fire.

Data-Driven Strategy

Use trends and incident data to guide patrol deployments and city resource allocation.

Vision Forward

Serve multiple jurisdictions and operate as a regional hub for surrounding agencies

Promote community involvement in the project and continue to establish best practices.

AUTOMATED LICENSE PLATE READER (ALPR) TECHNOLOGY

What is an Automated License Plate Reader?

A camera that captures license plates and vehicle characteristics-such as make, color, and body type-along with the date, time, and location of the observation.

HOW THE INFORMATION IS USED

Authorized personnel can search the information to help identify vehicles, generate investigative leads, and enhance public safety.

ALPR Systems Used by San Mateo Police Department

San Mateo Police Department uses both mobile and fixed ALPR technology.

MOBILE

AXON FLEET

MOBILE ALPR

Installed on equipped patrol vehicles and used while officers are in the field.

KEY FEATURES

- **ALPR** – Automatically reads license plates encountered by the patrol vehicle and can provide alerts or investigative information.
- **Forward-Facing/Dash Camera** - Records activity in front of the patrol vehicle, including traffic stops, pursuits, and other incidents.
- **In-Car Camera** – Captures activity inside the patrol vehicle, including the rear-seat area used for prisoner transport.
- **Integrated with Body-Worn Cameras** – Fleet and Axon body-worn cameras can operate as part of the same evidence ecosystem, helping coordinate recording and organize associated video evidence.
- **Data Sharing** - We are not sharing our Axon ALPR data with other agencies.

FIXED

FLOCK SAFETY

FIXED ALPR

Uses stationary cameras strategically placed throughout the community.

KEY FEATURES

- **ALPR** – Captures plates, including partial and temporary plates, along with vehicle information.
- **Real-Time Hotlist Alerts** – Checks detections against configured/NCIC hotlists and sends alerts when a potential match occurs.
- **Vehicle Signature Technology** – Searches by make, color, body type, racks, wheels, tool boxes, and other distinguishing features, including cases where a readable plate isn't available.
- **Investigative Search** – Searches historical vehicle detections using full/part plate and vehicle characteristics to develop leads.

Flock Safety

66
Total cameras

54
ALPR cameras

12
VMS cameras
(video only)

Stationary cameras provide fixed-location vehicle observations that support real-time alerts and retrospective investigative searches.

How Does a Flock Search Work?

1. Offense Type

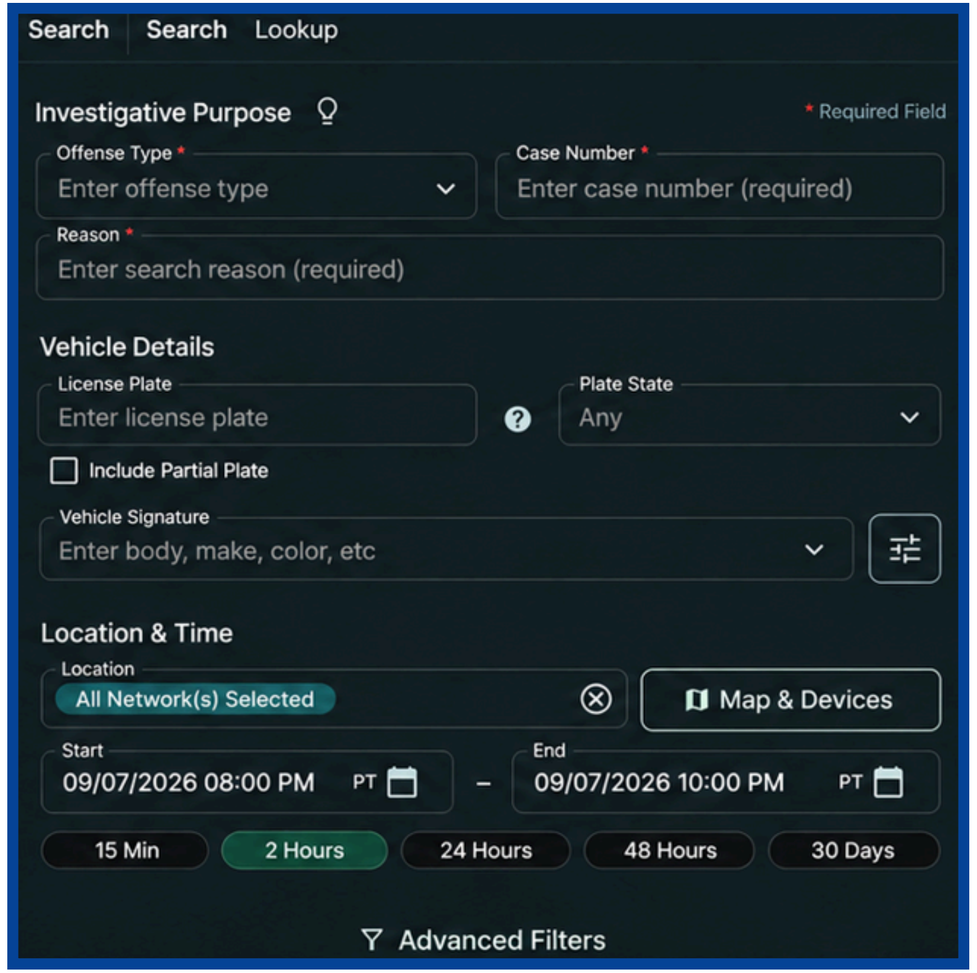
Select the offense type that best matches the investigation.

2. Case Number

Enter the case number to connect the search to the related investigation.

3. Reason for Search

Briefly explain the legitimate law enforcement purpose for accessing ALPR data.

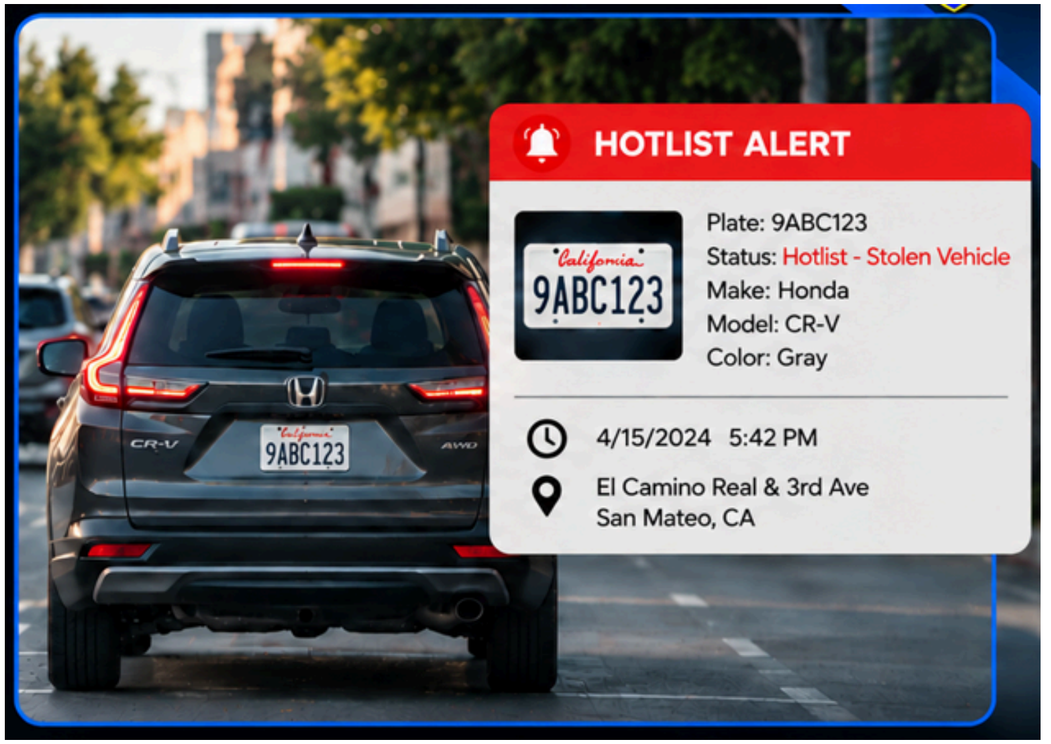


Why do these fields matter?

- Required fields create a clear, reviewable audit trail.
- The audit trail records who conducted the search, what was searched, and the documented purpose.
- This supports accountability, transparency, and compliance with department policy.

How Do Hotlist Alerts Work?

- Flock cameras automatically compare detected license plates against Hotlist records.
- Hotlists identify vehicles of interest, such as:
  - Stolen vehicles
  - Wanted vehicles
  - Vehicles associated with specific law-enforcement investigations
  - Missing/endangered person(s)
- Flock can receive Hotlist information originating from the National Crime Information Center (NCIC).



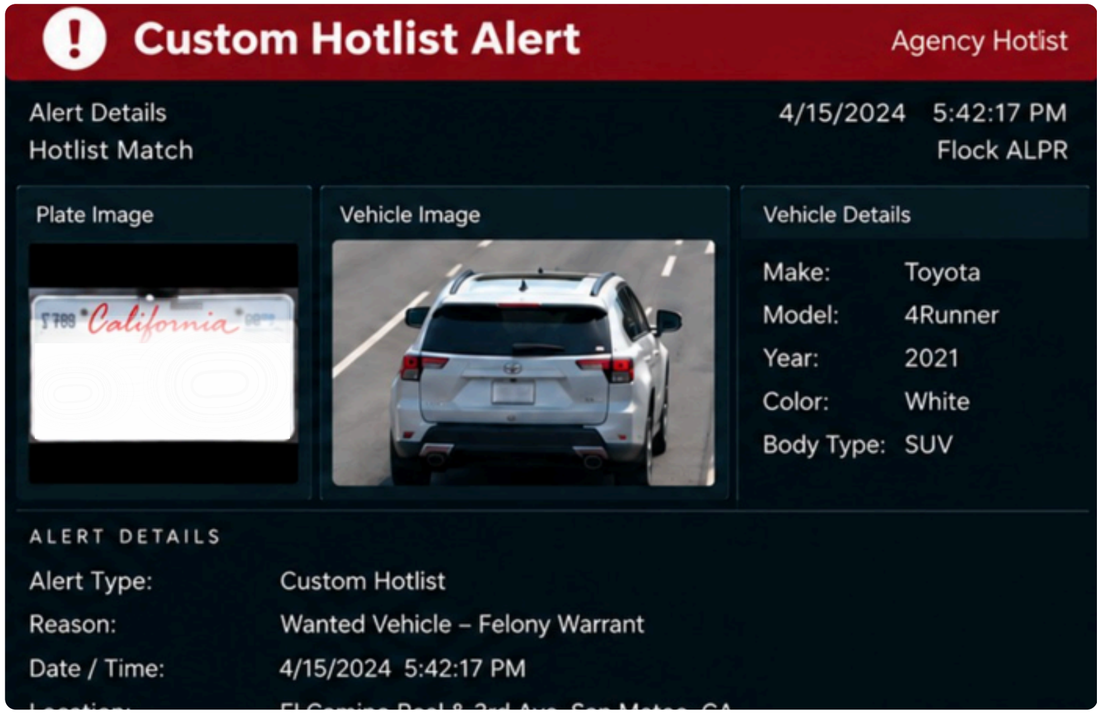
Custom Hotlist Alerts

Agency-created list of vehicles or plates tied to a legitimate law-enforcement purpose.

Entries are manually added by authorized personnel.

May include BOLOs, wanted vehicles, investigative leads, and missing/endangered persons.

Flock cameras automatically check plates and send real-time alerts on matches.



Data Sharing

Local Control

San Mateo PD sets data sharing settings and policies. Nothing is shared unless we choose to share it.

Authorization Required

Any sharing of ALPR data must be specifically authorized by San Mateo PD through a data sharing agreement.

Consistent with Policy and Law

All data sharing agreements must be consistent with San Mateo PD policies and applicable law.

Purpose-Driven

We only share data when it supports legitimate law-enforcement purposes and enhances public safety.

Network Data Sharing

The organizations below have been granted access to San Mateo PD data:

What Flock LPRs Do and Don’t Do

Federal Sharing Safeguards

Flock does not contract with ICE.

No Data Resale

Flock does not sell or share LPR data and is not a data broker.

Breach & Security Risk

Flock uses CJIS-aligned controls (including encryption at rest and in transit) and our cloud has never been compromised.

Built in Transparency

Flock offers permanent audit trails, automatic data deletion, and transparency portals.

What Flock LPRs Collect (and What We Don’t)

COLLECTED

License Plate Text, Date/Time, Camera Location, and Basic Vehicle Attributes (Make/Model/Color) - All Observable From Public Roadways.

NOT COLLECTED

Names, Addresses, Phone Numbers, Driver Identity, Biometric Identifiers, or Other Confidential Personal Information.

Bottom line: Flock’s LPR is not connected to DMV records and does not build a database of people, only vehicle attributes already visible in public.

California Specific Guardrails

SB 34
ALPR Privacy & Data Sharing

- Requires safeguards for ALPR data.
- Requires a public ALPR use and privacy policy.
- Limits ALPR data sharing to California public agencies.

SB 54
Immigration Enforcement

- Limits local resources used for immigration enforcement.
- We do not share ALPR data for immigration-enforcement purposes.
- Restricts ALPR access and sharing consistent with state and federal law.

Key Distinctions: SB 34 governs ALPR privacy and sharing; SB 54 limits use for immigration enforcement.

Flock Accountability & Transparency

AUTHORIZED ACCESS
Every search is tied to an authorized user.

REQUIRED PURPOSE
Users document the offense type, reason for the search, and case number.

AUDIT TRAIL
All searches are recorded and reviewable.

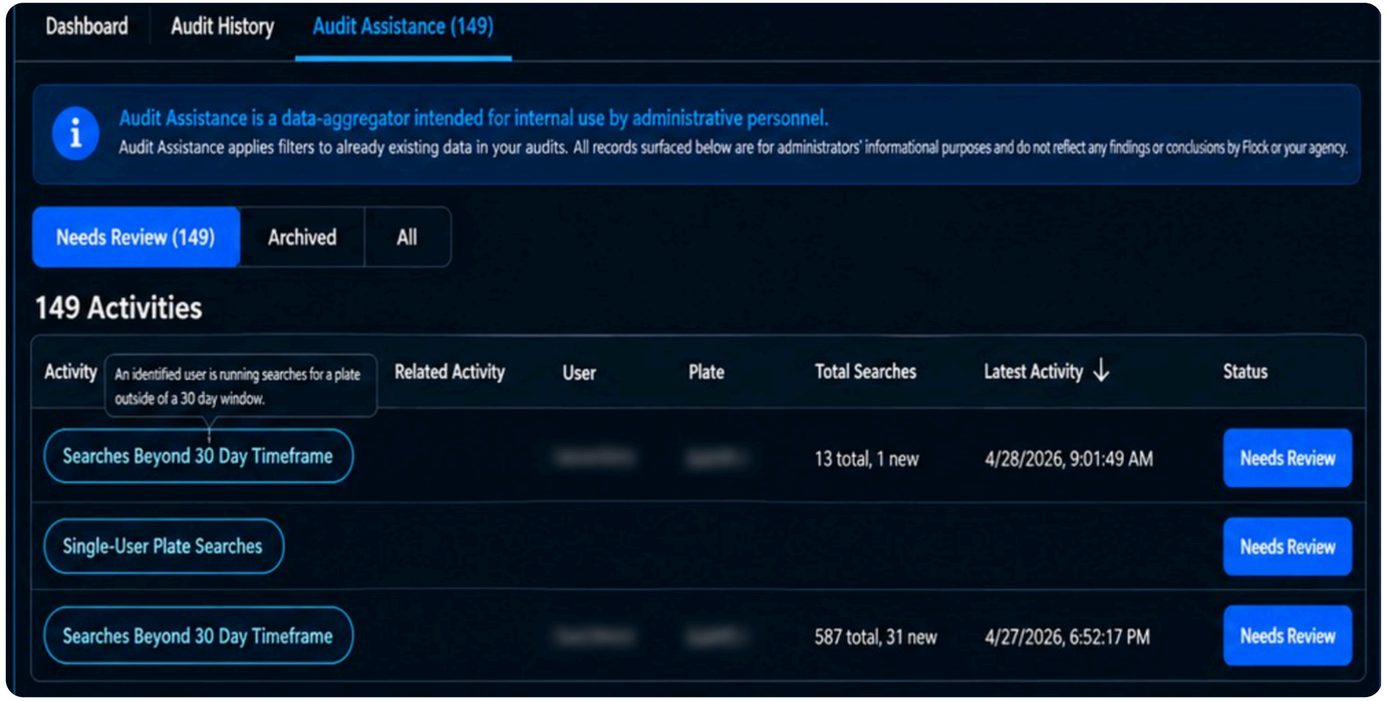
CLEAR VISIBILITY
Audits show who searched, what was searched, and why.

ONGOING REVIEW
Regular audits support policy compliance and help identify potential misuse.

Audit Assistance

Surfaces atypical search patterns and flags them for admin review, making it easier to have oversight on how the system is used.

Flock recommends best auditing practices for customers, encouraging a reliable rhythm of oversight.



San Mateo PD Transparency Portal

DATA. ACCOUNTABILITY. COMMUNITY TRUST.

Community Impact

Data Retention
The number of days data is retained.
30 days

Total Cameras
Number of LPR and other cameras.
66

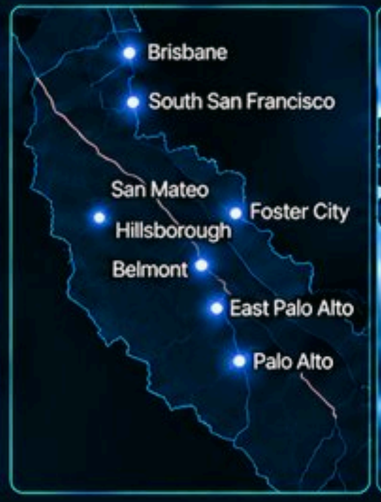
Vehicles Detected in Last 30 Days
Number of unique plate reads over the last 30 days.
897,977

Hotlists Alerted On
National and statewide hotlist sources.
California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

Sharing Network Data With

Organizations granted access to San Mateo PD data.

- Belmont CA PD
- Brisbane CA PD
- California Highway Patrol
- East Palo Alto CA PD
- Foster City CA PD
- Hillsborough CA PD
- Palo Alto CA PD
- South San Francisco CA PD



Policy & Trust

CLEAR POLICIES. RESPONSIBLE USE. A SAFER COMMUNITY.

What's Detected
License Plates, Vehicles

What's Not Detected
Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race

Acceptable Use Policy
Data is used for law enforcement purposes only. Data is owned by San Mateo PD and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Prohibited Uses
Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement, harassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), Personal use.

Access Policy
All system access requires a valid reason and is stored indefinitely.

Hotlist Policy
Hotlist hits are required to be human verified prior to action.

Public Search Audit
Download to view searches performed over the last 30 days.

Download CSV

More Info

Policy Documents
San Mateo PD Full Policy Manual can be found at the following link:
https://www.cityofsanmateo.org/DocumentCenter/View/79089/San-Mateo-PD-Policy-Manual

ALPR Policy
https://www.cityofsanmateo.org/DocumentCenter/View/107284/Automated-License-Plate-Readers-ALPRs-Policy-463

SOP
https://www.cityofsanmateo.org/DocumentCenter/View/90451/Unlicensed-License-Plate-Reader-Operating-Proce

Accountability & Transparency

Policy & Public Transparency	Access & User Controls	Sharing Controls	Auditing & Oversight
Updated the public portal with the Public Audit, ALPR Policy, SOP, and verified camera count.	Restricted Admin access to Lt. Pak, Lt. Casazza, and Sgt. Trujillo.	Removed sharing with all university police departments.	Moved network and organizational audits from quarterly to monthly.
Reviewed and cleaned up the ALPR Policy and SOP.	Reviewed all user roles and assigned personnel to the correct permissions.	Limited approved sharing permissions to Search and Alerts only.	Strengthened oversight of system access, sharing, search documentation, and user permissions.
Added another case # or CAD # to the search platform and removed “Other” as a search reason.	Limited Custom Hotlist creation to RTIC, Supervisors, Bureau, or CRU.	Centralized Sharing Request approvals through Lt. Casazza.	

Training & Ongoing Compliance

Standardizing training, documentation, and continuing education.

TRAINING DOCUMENTATION

Entered Employee Flock training records into METR, including the date of training. Retrained department users so everyone has current knowledge of the Flock System.

FLOCK COMMITTEE DEVELOPMENT

Flock Committee members engage in ongoing Flock Academy training and professional development. Continuing education keeps committee members current on system capabilities and safeguards.

PATROL SERGEANT TRAINING

Provided training on system use, Flock Academy, Audit Assistance features, Hotlists, Public Audit, and Sharing Requests. Reinforced expectations for accountability, proper system use, and supervisory oversight.

Result: Stronger governance, tighter access, controlled sharing, more frequent auditing, and better trained users.

Success Story

A REAL IMPACT ON PUBLIC SAFETY

01
The Crime

12/19/2020

A suspect, who was lying in wait, approached the victim as he approached his car. The suspect shot the victim several times, killing him, and then fled the scene.

02
Flock Lead

Through further investigation and with the assistance of a newly placed Flock camera, the suspect's vehicle was identified.

03
Investigation

A lengthy investigation led to two suspects who lived in Southern California.

04
Arrest

The two suspects were eventually located and arrested.

SAN MATEO
POLICE DEPARTMENT
INVESTIGATION

PROTECT WITH HONOR
SERVE WITH PRIDE

Without the Flock camera, we would not have had a lead on the suspect vehicle.

Success Story

A REAL IMPACT ON PUBLIC SAFETY

01
The Crime

8/04/2024

The suspect (victim's boyfriend) killed his girlfriend, who was 9 months pregnant. After killing her, the suspect stole the victim's car and fled the scene.

02
Flock Lead

Through further investigation and by utilizing Flock, it was learned that the suspect had fled to Southern California.

03
Investigation

In coordination with Southern California law enforcement agencies, the suspect was tracked down in the victim's car.

04
Arrest

After a standoff with the suspect, he was taken into custody.

05
Justice

The suspect was convicted of murder (x2) and is currently serving his sentence in prison.

Had it not been for Flock, this could have caused a delay in tracking this suspect down.

Our Commitment to Our Community

ALPR is one tool that helps our officers protect this community, but **how we use that tool matters**.

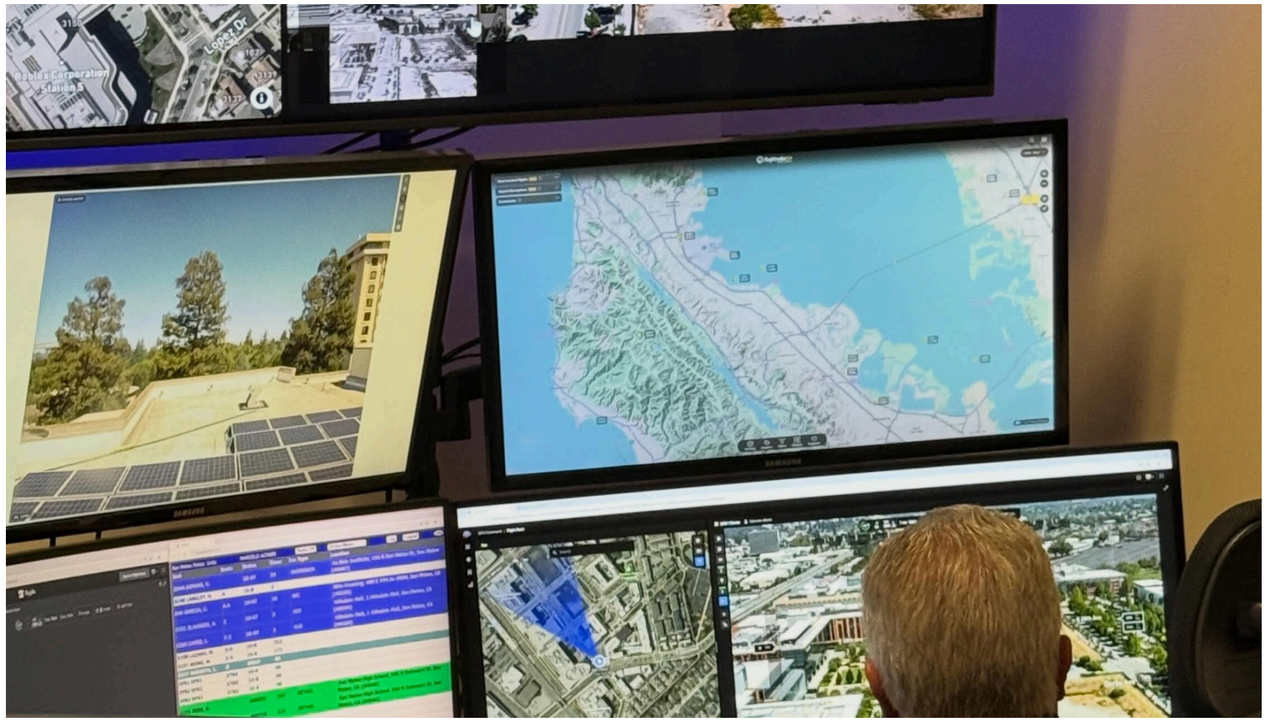
Our commitment is to use it with **purpose**, with **appropriate safeguards**, and with **meaningful oversight**.

We will continue to **evaluate our practices**, **protect privacy**, and remain **transparent and accountable** to the community we serve.

Public safety and public trust must always go hand in hand.

DRONE AS A FIRST RESPONDER (DFR)

Drone as a First Responder



A public safety tool that responds to a call for service ahead of the officers, providing aerial intelligence to the units on the ground. This allows us to assess the situation instantly, send the appropriate resources, and in many cases, cancel the dispatch entirely so police officers don't have to enter a neighborhood unnecessarily.

Drone as a First Responder

SMPD has partnered with Skydio for DFR.

- **X10 Docks – 3**
  - Docks are stationary and flown remotely from the RTIC.
- **X10 Field Deployed – 3**
  - Field deployed drones are deployed from our patrol vehicles.
- **R10 Interior – 5**
  - R10 drones are deployed inside structures ahead of officers keeping them out of harm’s way.

Why do we have a DFR Program?

- Rapid Situational Awareness
- Search and Rescue
- Fire Watch and Firefighting
- Critical Operations Support
- Increased Officer Safety
- Reduced Use of Force
- Delivery of Life-Saving Payloads
- De-escalation of situations
- HAZMAT incidents

DFR Workflow

1

Begins with a documented public safety purpose.

2

Addresses an identified concern within a defined area.

3

Limits observation to the purpose of the assignment.

4

Has a defined end point.

5

Does not permit random patrol flights or general surveillance.

Protecting Privacy

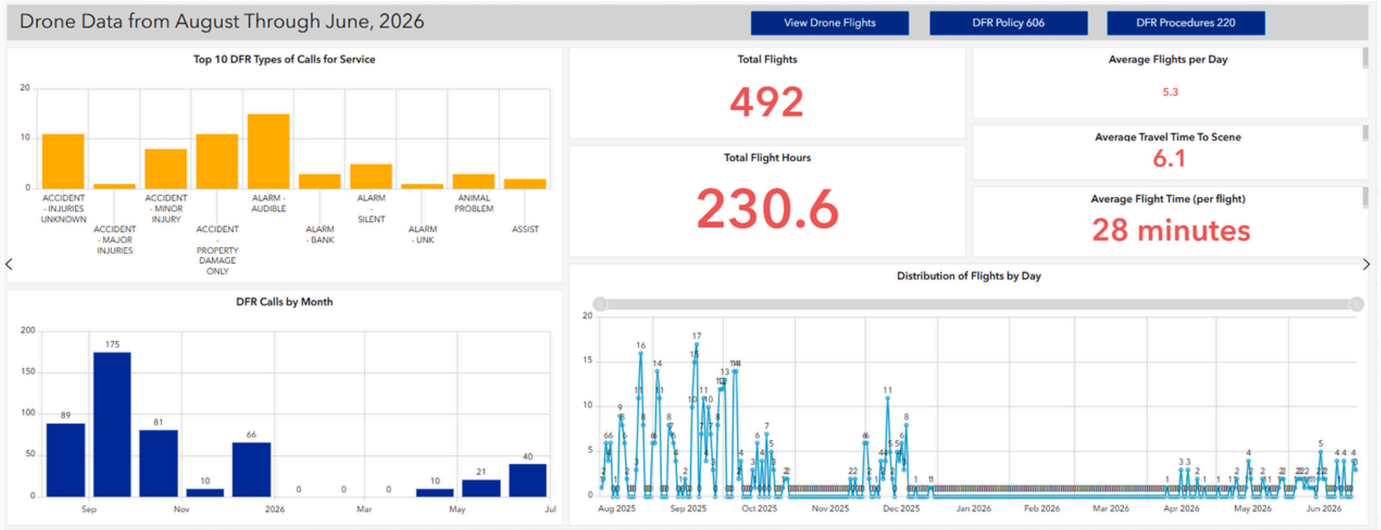
- Protecting community privacy is part of how we operate the DFR program.
- During a flight, our pilots keep the camera pointed toward the horizon to reduce incidental recording of people and private property along the flight path. Upon arrival, the camera focuses on the incident and the information needed to assist first responders. The process is repeated for return flights.
- We record every DFR flight from start to finish. That recording preserves a record of the operation that can be reviewed to evaluate how the drone and camera were used.
- The data is automatically uploaded to our CJIS compliant evidence software.
- These safeguards reduce unnecessary observation and help protect community privacy.

DFR Accountability: From Launch to Landing

1. Authorized purpose
2. Flight recorded
3. Camera use documented
4. Role-based access
5. Secured CJIS Compliant Cloud
6. Access audit trail
7. Retention/ deletion
8. Supervisor/Program Review

Transparency

- SMPD has a DFR program transparency page available to the public
- Flight logs and live flights are monitored weekly by the program manager
- DFR Policy is published online



What We Do

AUTHORIZED USES PER OUR POLICY

Only authorized operators who have completed the required training shall be permitted to operate the sUAS for the following purposes:

- Respond to calls for service
- Assist with the apprehension of criminal offenders
- To protect life, limb, and property
- Search and rescue / Disaster response
- Crime scene reconstruction / Mapping
- Individuals in physical or mental distress
- For infrastructure inspections emergency management and disaster response, or surveying and mapping.
- UAS program readiness activities including, but not limited to, training, certification, evaluation, and maintenance.
- Acts of terrorism / Mass casualty incidents

What We Don’t Do

UNAUTHORIZED USES PER OUR POLICY

- To conduct random surveillance activities.
- To target a person based solely on actual or perceived characteristics, such as race, ethnicity, national origin, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, economic status, age, cultural group, or disability.
- To harass, intimidate, or discriminate against any individual or group.
- To conduct any business other than official Department business.
- The UAS shall not be weaponized

Data Security

1 **Network security**
There is no sharing network.

2 **Authorized Users**
Only authorized viewers can see the drone video.

3 **Secure link access:**
Flight video is shared via a secure link to authorized viewers.

4 **Program manager notifications:**
All drone flights are sent via notification to the program manager.

5 **Vendor access**
SMPD controls all access to its DFR data.

6 **Data ownership**
We own all drone data.

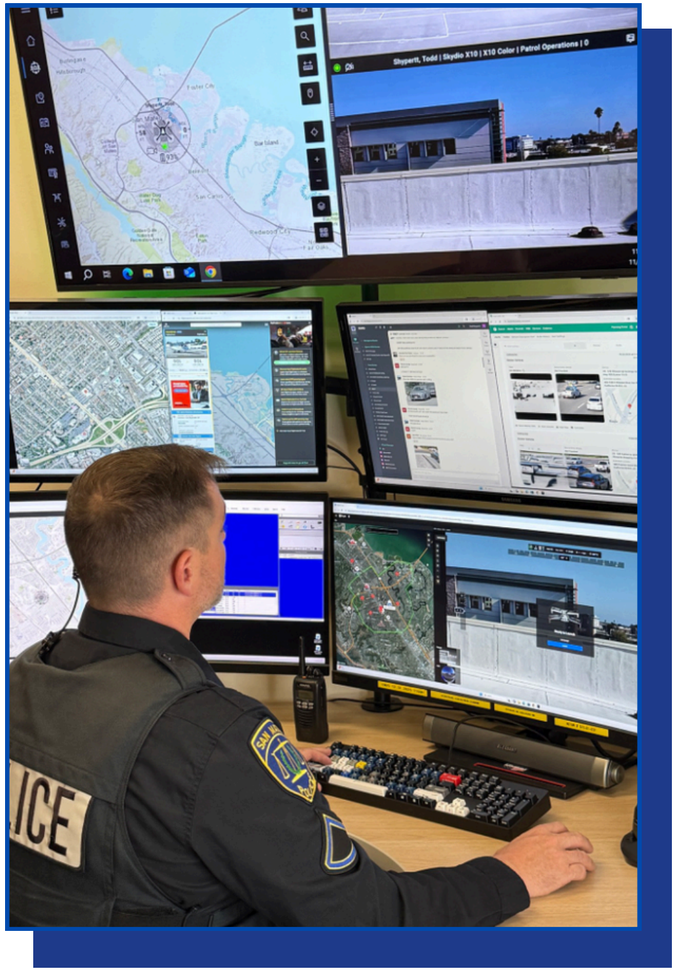
7 **Evidence storage**
All drone video is automatically uploaded to our secure CJIS compliant software.

RTIC Integration

The RTIC helps first responders understand what is happening at an incident. DFR provides a live aerial view that RTIC personnel can use to relay relevant information to officers and other emergency responders.

This can help responders locate someone who needs assistance, recognize hazards, and choose a safer approach before arriving, improving officer safety.

Using drone video within the RTIC does not expand the authorized purpose of the flight. The same mission limits, privacy protections, and restrictions on access and use continue to apply.



DFR Impact: 2024 to Present

3,348
Total Flights

694
People of Interest Located

414
Vehicles of Interest Located

116
Arrests Assisted

9
Search and Rescue

6
Scene Reconstructions

Not Just a Crime Fighter

Organized Retail Theft

4th of July Vehicle Pursuit

Injured Hiker at Laurelwood Park

Foster City Fire

THANK YOU

STUDY SESSION OCTOBER 2026